

Venkata Kandula

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PROFILE

- Around 8 years of experience in Quality Assurance with strong expertise in automation testing across Microservices-based, cloud-native, and UI applications in Healthcare Insurance and Product domains.
- Proficient in UI and API automation using Selenium WebDriver, Java, Python TestNG, Cucumber (BDD), Playwright, and Rest Assured.
- Experience in manual and automated mobile application testing across Android and iOS platforms, validating UI/UX, functionality, and cross-device compatibility.
- Hands-on exposure to mobile automation using Appium (or similar tools), integrating tests with CI/CD pipelines and collaborating with development teams to identify and resolve defects early.
- Strong hands-on programming experience in Core Java (OOPs, Collections, Streams, Exception Handling, Utilities) for framework development, reusable components, and test optimization.
- Adept at building scalable frameworks using Selenium, PyTest, JUnit5, and Cucumber (BDD) and integrating with Jenkins and Maven for full pipeline coverage.
- Experienced in designing POM, Hybrid, and Data-Driven automation frameworks, enabling maintainability, scalability, and faster regression cycles.
- Skilled in manual and automation testing including functional, regression, smoke, integration, system, and UAT testing in Agile (Scrum) environments.
- Strong experience with API/Web Services testing (REST & SOAP) using Rest Assured, Postman, and SoapUI, including schema validation, authentication, payload validation, and status validation.
- Hands-on with SQL database testing, ETL validation, and backend data verification across Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQL Server.
- Experienced integrating automation frameworks with CI/CD tools like Jenkins, Maven, Azure DevOps, and GitHub, supporting continuous testing and automation governance.
- Exposure to cloud-based test execution and working with distributed systems and microservices architectures including Kafka and Databricks for data validation/testing.
- Performed performance testing using JMeter and LoadRunner to evaluate load, scalability, and response time metrics.
- Hands-on experience in using GenAI-assisted automation tools (GitHub Copilot, OpenAI-powered assistants) to accelerate script development, defect analysis, and test case generation.

- Strong experience in defect lifecycle management and reporting using JIRA and ALM, ensuring traceability across requirements, test cases, execution, and defects.
- Experience mentoring junior QA engineers, participating in code reviews, test planning, sprint ceremonies, and leading improvements in automation strategy and QA best practices.

EDUCATION

Bapatla College of Engineering and Technology, Andhra Pradesh, India

Bachelor of Technology (B. Tech) in Information Technology | May 2016

SKILLS & AFFILIATIONS

Category	Tools / Technologies
Automation Tools	Selenium WebDriver, Playwright, TestNG, Cucumber (BDD), Page Object Model (POM)
Programming	Java, python,SQL, Gherkin
API Testing	Rest Assured, Postman, SoapUI
CI/CD & Build	Jenkins, Maven, Git
Databases	MySQL, Oracle, PostgreSQL, SQL Server
Performance	JMeter, LoadRunner
Defect Tracking	JIRA, ALM
IDE/Utilities	Eclipse, IntelliJ
Methodologies	Agile/Scrum, SDLC, STLC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Blue Yonder – Dallas, TX

Senior SDET | Feb 2024 – Present

- Lead the design, development, and execution of automated UI and API test scripts using Selenium WebDriver, Java, TestNG, and Rest Assured for functional, regression, smoke, and end-to-end testing.
- Designed scalable automation frameworks using POM, reusable utilities, and Java OOPs (Collections, Streams, Exception Handling) to improve maintainability and execution stability.
- Integrated automated tests into CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins & Maven, ensuring continuous integration and faster feedback loops.
- Performed API and Web Services testing using Postman, Rest Assured, and SOAP UI, validating request/response payloads, headers, schemas, and authentication flows.
- Worked with test management tools such as **JIRA, ALM/Quality Center**, and maintained test execution tracking and defect metrics.

- Validated backend systems and microservices built on Spring Boot architecture, including request routing, payload mapping, and JSON/XML structure validation.
- Performed Database testing with SQL (Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQL Server) for data integrity, ETL validation, and business rule verification.
- Exposure to NoSQL database concepts along with strong SQL-based backend validation experience.
- Developed and executed performance testing using JMeter and LoadRunner to analyze system scalability, response time, and bottleneck detection.
- Validated Kafka-based event-driven workflows and real-time data pipelines using Databricks for end-to-end data flow consistency.
- Executed **system integration and end-to-end regression testing** for multi-tier applications involving UI, APIs, microservices, and backend databases.
- Participated in code reviews and automation design discussions to enforce best coding and automation practices across the team.
- Analyzed failed builds/logs, reported defects in JIRA, and worked closely with development teams for faster root cause analysis and resolution.
- Created and maintained comprehensive test documentation including test plans, test cases, automation scripts, traceability matrices, and execution reports.
- Supported sprint ceremonies backlog grooming, refinement, sprint planning, daily standups, and retrospective meetings ensuring alignment with Agile delivery timelines.
- Identified automation gaps and implemented enhancements that reduced testing effort and improved regression suite stability.
- Integrated Playwright automation and API test suites into Google Cloud-based CI workflows for parallel execution.
- Mentored junior QA resources on automation best practices, debugging, and framework enhancements.
- Utilized GenAI test assistants (GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Models, TestGPT) for test case generation, code optimization, defect analysis, and faster automation script development.

Tools and Technologies used: Selenium WebDriver, Java, TestNG, Postman, Rest Assured, SOAP UI, SQL (Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQL Server), Jenkins, Maven, JMeter, LoadRunner, Databricks, Apache Kafka, JIRA,ALM,Zephyr, Agile/Scrum, GenAI.

Blue Cross Blue Shield – Chicago, IL

QA Automation Test Engineer | Nov 2022 – Jan 2024

- Performed testing for Medicare/Medicaid platforms including claims processing and membership validation systems.
- Validated Medicaid claims workflows, including claim submission, adjudication, eligibility checks, and EDI formats (837, 835, 270/271) in compliance with HIPAA standards

- Validated EDI transaction sets and provider data using Internet portals.
- Developed and maintained automation test scripts using Selenium WebDriver, Java, TestNG, and Maven for regression, smoke, and functional testing.
- Designed and implemented a BDD Automation Framework using Cucumber/Gherkin, including feature files, step definitions, reusable hooks, and reporting.
- Followed TDD principles using Java and JUnit to ensure early defect detection and strong unit-level validation.
- Built hybrid and data-driven frameworks, improving automation reusability, maintainability, and execution scalability.
- Automated REST API validation using Rest Assured and Postman, including response payload validation, schema validation, headers, authentication, and error handling.
- Executed manual and automation testing across functional, regression, smoke, UAT, and integration test phases.
- Performed cross-browser and parallel execution using TestNG and Selenium Grid across multiple environments (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge).
- Implemented Page Object Model (POM) architecture and reusable Java utilities for framework optimization.
- Conducted backend testing and ETL validation by writing SQL queries and database joins; integrated DB checks into automation using JDBC.
- Configured and managed CI/CD pipelines in Jenkins, scheduling nightly runs, post-deployment checks, and automated regression cycles.
- Worked in cloud-based environments for automation execution and deployment validation, ensuring test compatibility across distributed infrastructure.
- Generated Cucumber, HTML, Extent, and JSON reports with screenshots for failed executions to support triage and RCA.
- Logged and tracked defects using JIRA, worked closely with developers and business analysts for resolution and retesting.
- Participated in code reviews, sprint planning, refinement, and retrospective meetings, ensuring alignment with Agile QA processes.
- Coordinated and supported UAT execution, ensuring mapping of requirements to automated and manual test coverage.
- Performed performance testing (JMeter) to identify response time issues and system bottlenecks.
- Ensured traceability using RTM, maintaining consistent alignment between requirements, test cases, execution results, and defect tracking.
- Prepared test plans, test cases, and execution documentation, aligning with QA best practices and internal compliance standards.

Tools and Technologies used: Selenium WebDriver, Java, TestNG, Cucumber (BDD), Rest Assured, Postman, SQL, JMeter, Maven, Jenkins, JIRA, Zephyr, Git

Selectsys – Hyderabad, India

Associate Quality Analyst | Jan 2018 – Mar 2021

- Designed and executed end-to-end test automation for an enterprise insurance application, covering both UI and API layers.
- Developed scalable backend automation frameworks using Core Java (OOP, Collections, Streams) and reusable helper utilities to support maintainable automation suites.
- Built and executed automation scripts using Selenium WebDriver, TestNG with data-driven test execution using Apache POI for externalized test input.
- Automated REST API validations using Postman scripting and Rest Assured, validating schema, status codes, payloads, and request-response mapping.
- Performed backend database validation using complex SQL queries to support ETL testing, data reconciliation, and integration validation across environments.
- Implemented BDD automation framework using Cucumber/Gherkin, writing feature files, reusable step definitions, and execution hooks.
- Experience in manual and automated mobile application testing across Android and iOS platforms, validating UI/UX, functionality, and cross-device compatibility.
- Hands-on exposure to mobile automation using Appium (or similar tools), integrating tests with CI/CD pipelines and collaborating with development teams to identify and resolve defects early.
- Integrated automation suites into CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and Azure DevOps to support nightly regression, continuous feedback, and scheduled smoke test execution.
- Collaborated closely with development teams during code reviews and defect triage sessions to improve automation quality, maintainability, and execution stability.
- Supported cloud migration efforts by validating functionality and automation compatibility during platform transition to cloud-based architecture.
- Participated in complete Agile delivery lifecycle requirements review, sprint planning, test execution, reporting, retrospectives ensuring story readiness and coverage.
- Reported and tracked defects using Jira, maintaining clear traceability between user stories, test cases, automation coverage, and execution results.
- Assisted UAT and production validation by preparing test data, executing high-priority functional flows, and sharing test evidence with business stakeholders.

Tools and Technologies used: Selenium WebDriver, TestNG, JUnit, Cucumber (BDD with Gherkin), Java, SQL, Rest Assured, Postman, SoapUI, Maven, Jenkins, Git, JIRA, Eclipse, IntelliJ, Agile/Scrum

SNF India Pvt Ltd – Visakhapatnam, India

Quality Analyst | Jun 2016 – Dec 2017

- Worked closely with developers, business analysts, and QA leads to understand system requirements and functional specifications.

- Prepared detailed test scenarios, test cases, and test data based on business requirements and acceptance criteria.
- Performed various testing types including functional, integration, regression, smoke, positive/negative testing, and UI validation.
- Participated in Agile ceremonies such as sprint planning, daily stand-ups, backlog grooming, and sprint retrospective meetings.
- Executed manual test cases and documented results, ensuring full traceability to business and system requirements.
- Identified, logged, and tracked defects using JIRA/ALM, retesting fixes and updating defect status throughout the lifecycle.
- Performed basic database testing by writing SQL queries to validate data integrity, back-end validations, and business rules.
- Collaborated in review meetings with cross-functional teams and provided weekly QA progress and defect summary reports.
- Supported UAT testing, helping business users validate functionality, prepare test data, and track issues to closure.
- Gained initial exposure to automation using Selenium WebDriver with Java, primarily to understand framework structure and execute existing scripts.

Tools and Technologies used: JIRA, ALM, SQL Server, Postman, Selenium WebDriver, Java, TestNG exposure, Agile/Scrum, MS Excel.